

Myera Rashid

CONTACT INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University
PhD in Economics

Aug 2021 - present

University of Chicago
M.A. in Social Sciences

Sep 2018 - June 2019

New York University Abu Dhabi
B.A. (Hons.) in Mathematics and Economics

Aug 2014 - May 2018

FIELDS

Economic History, Labor Economics, Gender Economics

REFERENCES

Joel Mokyr
Professor of Economics
Northwestern University
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W. Walker Hanlon
Associate Professor of Economics
Northwestern University
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Abi Adams
Professor of Economics
Northwestern University
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Leah Boustan
Professor of Economics
Yale University
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WORKING PAPERS

**“Keys to Upward Mobility: Typewriter Adoption and Women’s Economic Outcomes”
Revise and Resubmit, *American Economic Review***

Abstract: Workplace technological changes were instrumental in creating new tasks for women over the last century. This paper studies the adoption of the typewriter into US workplaces. Exploiting exogenous variation in typist demand across sectors, I document that the typewriter increased women’s labor force participation, leading to lower rates of marriage and fertility. These developments stemmed from a transition of White women from households into office work and an indirect crowding-in effect drawing Black women into domestic services. Acting as a “meeting technology,” the typewriter reshaped social interactions, enabling White women to marry above their socioeconomic backgrounds and achieve upward mobility.

“Marriage and the Intergenerational Mobility of Women: Evidence from Marriage Certificates, 1850-1920” with Katherine Eriksson, Gregory Niemesh and Jacqueline Craig

Abstract: We document that women’s economic mobility improved nearly a century before married women gained broad labor market opportunities. Using Massachusetts marriage registers linked to U.S. censuses (1850–1920), we create new father–child links for women to estimate intergenerational mobility and assortative mating, overcoming a key historical linkage barrier. Estimates from a structural marriage market model suggest assortative mating fell 61% from 1850–1870 to 1900–1920. Counterfactuals imply women’s mobility would have been far lower absent the decline in assortative mating. Had late cohorts faced early cohort sorting, the rank–rank slope between a woman’s father and husband would have been 2.5 times higher.

PUBLICATIONS	“Finding John Smith: Using Extra Information for Historical Record Linkage” with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, Harriet Brookes Gray and Santiago Pérez Forthcoming, <i>Explorations in Economic History</i> Abstract: We introduce and assess the performance of a new rule-based, fully automated linking algorithm for historical Census records that adds five matching characteristics – namely middle initial, county of residence, spouse’s name, mother’s name, and father’s name – to the basic “ABE” linking algorithms (Abramitzky, Boustan, and Eriksson 2012, 2014, 2017). Relative to the basic ABE algorithms, “ABE with Extra Information” (or “ABE-EI”) produces greatly increased match rates, without sacrificing accuracy or representativeness. ABE-EI achieves match rates on par with or slightly below machine- learning based algorithms with extra information (BYU or MLP). Regression analysis suggests that improvements in link accuracy helps to diminish attenuation bias.	
PUBLISHED DATASET	Census Linking Project <i>Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, Katherine Eriksson, Santiago Pérez and Myera Rashid. Census Linking Project: Version 2.0 [dataset]. 2020. https://censuslinkingproject.org</i>	
SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS	“How Occupations Become Gendered: Social Learning and the Long-Run Evolution of Women’s Work” “Excluded Women: The Fall of Married Women’s Labor Force Participation” with Marie-Louise Décamps and Laura Murphy “The Immigrant Advantage in US Intergenerational Mobility” with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, Elisa Jácome, Santiago Pérez, and Jonathan Rothbaum “The Black-White Mobility Gap: The Role of Religious Institutions in the US” with Nicole Saito	
INVITED CONFERENCES, SEMINARS & PRESENTATIONS	2026: NBER Development of the American Economy Summer Institute (Poster), NBER Gender in the Economy Summer Institute, Stanford Graduate Economic History Workshop, Economic History Association Annual Conference (Poster), Columbia Gender in the Global Economy Conference 2025: NBER Development of the American Economy Summer Institute, NBER Gender in the Economy Summer Institute, Opportunity Insights Conference on Economic Mobility, Paris School of Economics: Economic History Seminar 2024: Stanford Institute of Theoretical Economics Conference: Gender Session, Harvard Graduate Workshop in Economic History, NBER Development of the American Economy Summer Institute, Economic History Association Annual Meeting, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Cliometrics Conference 2023: Yale Economic History Workshop, NBER Economics of Mobility Fall Meeting, Western Economic Association International Annual Meeting 2022: Economic History Association Annual Meeting	
GRANTS, AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS	Russell Sage Foundation Dissertation Research Grant	<i>2025</i>
	Sokoloff Dissertation Fellowship <i>Economic History Association</i>	<i>2025</i>
	NBER Gender in the Economy Fellowship, <i>Runner Up</i>	<i>2025</i>
	Robert Eisner Graduate Fellowship For Excellence in Research and Teaching <i>Northwestern, Dept. of Economics</i>	<i>Sep 2024-June 2025</i>

	Engerman-Goldin Prize For the “Census Linking Project” <i>Economic History Association</i>	2024
	Northwestern DPD Program Grant	June-Sep 2024
	Early Dissertation Grant <i>Economic History Association</i>	March 2024
	Templeton Trust Religion and Development Grant	September 2023
	Price Theory Summer Camp <i>University of Chicago BFI</i>	June 2023
REFeree SERVICE	<i>American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Explorations in Economic History, Journal of Economic History, Journal of Human Resources, Review of Economics and Statistics, Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>	
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	RA to Abi Adams Northwestern University	Jan 2026 - March 2026
	RA to Elisa Jácome Northwestern University	June 2023 - Dec 2024
	RA to Walker Hanlon Northwestern University	Sep 2022 - March 2023
	RA to Joel Mokyr Northwestern University	June 2022 - Aug 2022
	RA to Leah Boustan & Ran Abramitzky Princeton University	Aug 2019 - July 2021
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Undergraduate Western Economic History Teaching Assistant for Prof. Walker Hanlon Northwestern University Median Evaluation Rating: 6/6	Spring 2023
	Course Guest Lectures: Economics of the Family , Prof. Abi Adams (Northwestern) History of American Technology , Prof. Ken Alder (Northwestern)	
DEPARTMENT & PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	Undergraduate Women in Economics, <i>Panelist</i> Economic History Advising Group, <i>Organizer</i> Graduate Studies Committee, <i>Student Representative</i> Development Student Workshop, <i>Organizer</i> Graduate Women in Economics Student Meetings, <i>Organizer</i> Economics PhD Students Mentorship, <i>Mentor</i>	May 2026 Jan 2025 - March 2025 Sep 2023 - June 2024 Sep 2023 - June 2024 Sep 2022 - Dec 2023 Sep 2022 - Present
ADDITIONAL INFORMATION	Programming: STATA, Python, R, ArcGIS Languages: English (native fluency); Urdu, Punjabi (native); French, Arabic (intermediate) Other: Special Sworn Status, US Census Bureau	